

# CREDIT CARDS AND RETAIL FIRMS: HISTORICAL EVIDENCE FROM THE UNITED STATES

Joseph P. Hall

Georgia Institute of Technology  
jhall390@gatech.edu

August 10, 2026

**Acknowledgments.** I thank Amit Seru, Greg Buchak, Arvind Krishnamurthy, Stephen Haber, Christopher Tonetti, Sarah Anderson, Susan Cherry, Antonio Coppola, José Ignacio Cuesta, Mohammad Davoodalhosseini (discussant), Liran Einav, Benjamin Hébert, Kim P. Huynh, Claudia Robles-Garcia, Lulu Wang, Chenzi Xu, Oliver Xie, Christine Zulehner (discussant), and Jeffrey Zweibel, as well as two anonymous referees, for various assistance, comments, and advice. I thank seminar participants for useful comments at the InterFinance Online Seminar, the SEC Division of Economic Risk Analysis, the Cherry Blossom Financial Institute, the Bank of Canada, the Financial Services Innovation Lab at the Georgia Institute of Technology, the Virtual Household Finance Seminar, the Economics of Payments XIII Conference, and the Canadian Economics Association 2026 annual meeting. I thank the GSB LEAD fund and SIEPR for financial support, and Hitech Digital Solutions and Sarah Anderson for data collection and auditing. All code and public data for this project are available at <https://github.com/josephhall15959/consumer-finance>.